



Killing time in smog and IPL auction fever hits home!

Our correspondents bring you the highlights and intriguing moments, both on and off the field, from the **fifth round** of Ranji Trophy fixtures.

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Cricket is probably the only sport where players warm up for a game by playing another sport.

Imagine Novak Djokovic whipping out a cricket bat

before a Wimbledon final and playing a couple of straight drives into the net. Too much grass on the surface, he would say. Sorry!

As the start of the Ranji Trophy match between Haryana and Kerala was delayed due to an unexpected bout of smog, this unique occurrence was on full display.

Both teams started with a game of

foot volley — separately, of course — with training hurdles and plastic chairs acting as make-shift nets.

Evidently, one team was better at this sport than the other. While one struggled to maintain rallies with their stiff footwork, it was boringly easy for the other. You know which one is which. Trust the stereotype.

Soon enough, the Kerala players